



- A question can be **just a word**, such as *Who?*, *What?*, *Where?*, *When?*, *Why?*, or *How?*
- A question mark **should not** normally be used with **another punctuation mark**. One **exception** is when a **period** is used with an abbreviation at the end of a sentence. For example, “Should we meet at 3:00 p.m.?”
- When a question mark appears within a title that is **italicized**, the question mark should also be italicized.

In **Spanish**, an **inverted question mark** (¿) is used to indicate the **beginning** of a question, in addition to the question mark at the end.

Tag questions

A tag question is one that can be added to the end of a statement. The speaker prompts the listener to respond in a certain way, and then adds the question to the end for confirmation. Tag questions follow a comma at the end of a statement.

This is a statement that makes sense on its own.

You don't think I'm responsible, **do you?**



This is the question, but it cannot appear on its own because it doesn't make sense without the rest of the sentence.

Rhetorical questions

A rhetorical question is a question that is asked only to stress a point. It often contains a note of emotion or sometimes exaggeration. No response is expected, since the answer to the question is either obvious or cannot be known. Rhetorical questions are punctuated with a question mark.

Do I look like a cat thief?

No response is expected, because the speaker does not think she looks like a cat thief.



REAL WORLD

Can we help you?

Occasionally, question marks are used to indicate tourist information points on signs. Signs like this exist in many places, but are particularly useful for tourists in countries where the spoken language is written in a different alphabet, such as in Japan.



GLOSSARY

Abbreviation A shortened form of a word, often with one or more periods to represent missing letters.

Italics A style of type in which the letters are printed at an angle to resemble handwriting.

Phrase A group of words that does not contain a verb.

Question A sentence that asks for information.

Statement A sentence that conveys a fact or piece of information.

Subject The person or thing that is performing the action of the verb.